

**Consultation
on changes to the
Transport Policy for
Children and Young
People with Special
Educational Needs**

February 2014

Consultation Document

What are we proposing to do?

This consultation document is about proposed changes to the Transport Policy for children and young people with special educational needs and disabilities (SEND).

It is proposed that the county council:

- introduces a parental contribution for discretionary Post 16 transport support of £475 per annum with effect from September 2014.
- applies a formulaic increase to future years' concessionary charge that is on the basis of Retail Price Index (RPI) plus 5%.

The proposed changes would ensure that transport provision for children and young people with special educational needs and disabilities can continue to be provided in a transparent, supportive and cost-effective way for families.

It is proposed that the changes will be introduced from September 2014.

The county council wants to hear your views on these important proposals. If you have difficulty in accessing this information, please contact the Inclusion and Disability Support Service on:

Telephone **01772 532241** or **01772 530839** or email us at **idss@lancashire.gov.uk**

Foreword



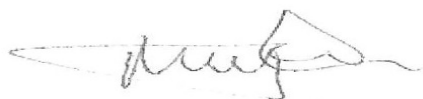
In Lancashire, we believe that children and young people come first. We want them to enjoy their time at school, make good progress, and achieve their best. This is particularly so for those children and young people who have a special educational need or disability (SEND).

Lancashire County Council is facing cuts in funding of up to £300m over the coming years. Transporting children and young people with special educational needs and disabilities to and from school or college is very costly.

Over the last seven years the cost of home to school transport for children and young people who have a special educational need or disability has significantly increased. It is important that we work together to deliver high quality services to families in genuine need and reduce inefficiencies wherever possible.

The county council works together with parents and other service providers to help our children to be safe, to enjoy and achieve, to be listened to, to belong to the community and to achieve economic wellbeing.

I hope that you will take a little time during this consultation period to let us know your views on what we are proposing to do. We will not make a decision until we have carefully considered all responses to this consultation.

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read 'Matthew Tomlinson', written in a cursive style.

County Councillor Matthew Tomlinson
Cabinet Member for Children, Young People and Schools